

Cecile Trijssenaar - Story Teller, Anthropologist, Film Maker, Journalist, Tiger Mother, Adoption Advocate, Defender of Equality & Inclusion, Bach Flower & Wellbeing therapist...

I met Cecile more than twenty years ago at her home in Chiswick. She was hosting an open house for the preadoption community. Her enthusiastic desire to adopt from Russia was inspiring and I was in awe of her intention to navigate the Russian adoption process herself. I later learned that she was spending a great deal of time in St Petersburg, working tirelessly to make Sasha's adoption possible.

We met up with Cecile and Sasha at the Easter and Christmas RUKA parties while the children were small. Cecile had boundless energy and was often at the centre of activity.

In her work as an adoption facilitator Cecile navigated complex adoption processes to benefit other children and families. She was passionate, determined, and undaunted by the complexity of the process.

Cecile was a Tiger Mother to Sasha, who she so clearly adored. She despaired at a flawed education system and battled with authorities. She highlighted injustice, keenly sensing hidden agendas that masked bigotry. Despite sometimes being a lone voice, she determinedly stood her ground.

I became closer to Cecile when Cecile and Sasha were living in Bournemouth and after reconnecting at RUKA meet ups. I remember staying up until 3 am chatting with Cecile after a day at Go Ape in the Forest of Dean. We later spent days on the beach in Dorset, creating memories I treasure. Cecile was wonderfully supportive to me and to Kit during challenging times. She was interested, caring and forthright.

A warrior when she needed to be Cecile was warm, caring and nurturing. She was an authentic, wise, and generous friend.

Tricia and Kit Pearce